Important changes to the 2012/13 to 2018/19 CSEW

The CSEW datasets now available for the years 2012/13 to 2018/19 are based upon a new methodology of capping the number of incidents at the 98th percentile.

Incidence variables names have remained consistent with previously supplied data but due to the fact they are based on the new 98th percentile cap, and old data sets are not, comparability has been lost with years prior to 2012/13.

More information can be found in the user guide that accompanies the 2017/18 dataset and includes a list of all variables affected. Please note a comprehensive metadata guide for the revised historic back series will be available soon.

We intend to publish all micro data back to 1981 with incident data based on the 98th percentile cap later in 2020. In the meantime, we thank all users of our microdata for their patience.

10-15s datasets based on the new methodology are now available for years back to 2012-13. Therefore, comparability with previous years for the children's survey is limited to the years 2018-19 and 2012-13. We aim to provide the remaining children's datasets later in the year with the remaining adults CSEW data.

If you have any questions, please refer to the user guide or email crimestatistics@ons.gov.uk.

For more information on the methodological change please see the article 'Improving victimisation estimates derived from the Crime Survey for England and Wales'.